SQUASH AND MOSTARDA FILLING

INGREDIENTS

900 g	Delicata squash
900 g	Butternut squash
60 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper
42 g	Olive oil
3 sprigs	Rosemary
5 sprigs	Thyme
40 g	Garlic
232 g	Ricotta
30 g	Apple or pear mostarda, finely chopped
90 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
quantity not given	Nutmeg, whole

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F.
2. Halve both squashes lengthwise and scrape out the seeds and fibers.
3. Set the halves on a sheet pan, hollow side up, and divide the butter between the cavities. Season with salt and pepper. Drizzle the olive oil over, then strew the rosemary, thyme and garlic around them.
4. Roast 45 minutes to 1 hour, until a fork slides in easily.
5. Let the squash cool. Pull out the garlic and herbs and throw them away.
6. Scoop the flesh out of the skins and discard the skins. You are after about 450 g of flesh.
7. Stand a cheesecloth-lined chinois or fine-mesh strainer over a bowl. Spoon the flesh in, lay parchment or plastic wrap directly on the surface and press it down under a plate. The parchment is there so the squash does not stick to the plate. Refrigerate at least 2 hours, or overnight, and let the liquid seep out.
8. Pass the drained squash through a tamis or fine-mesh strainer into a bowl.
9. Pulse the ricotta in a food processor only until it turns as smooth as cake frosting, with a sheen on it. Stop there, because longer will break it. Add it to the squash.
10. Mix in the mostarda and the parmigiano. Season with salt and pepper and about 15 gratings of nutmeg. It should taste well seasoned. Refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

NOTES

900 g each of delicata and butternut gives about 450 g of roasted flesh once the skins and seeds are out.
The 2-hour weighted drain is the step that decides the texture. Skip it and the filling is watery and too loose to hold a seal.
Delicata mixed with a smaller measure of butternut or Honeynut keeps the filling from turning too sweet. Capel da Pret, the gray-skinned pumpkin grown around Mantua, is firmer and carries less sugar than the pumpkins sold in the US, so pumpkin is not a straight swap.
Hold the nutmeg at about 15 gratings. The spice blooms as the pasta cooks.
Quince mostarda is traditional. Apple or pear mostarda replaces it. Mustard extract, which gives the original its pungency, is banned as a foodstuff in the United States because its erucic acid content can be toxic.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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